Our ref:
Your ref: S/OUT/13/1555

Level 1
Ash House
Falcon Road
Sowton Industrial Estate
Exeter EX2 7LB

Direct Line: 01392 312570

Swindon Borough Council
Wat Tyler House
Beckhampton Street
Swindon SN1 2JH

10 December 2013

For the attention of Miss Sam Howell

Dear Miss Howell

EASTERN VILLAGES, LAND NORTH OF A420 SOUTH MARSTON AND ROWBOROUGH, SWINDON

Thank you for consulting the Highways Agency with regards to the Eastern Villages planning application submitted by the Swindon Eastern Villages Consortium.

The Agency recognises that a prosperous society depends on our roads. So it aims to support growth and facilitate development, based on understanding of traffic conditions and behaviour, to manage the effects of development and ensure road safety. Sometimes we need extra information or evidence to give sound advice to local planning authorities and may need to direct them to defer planning decisions while we obtain or assess such information.

The Highways Agency has been in consultation with Brookbanks (Applicants Transport Consultants) as part of the pre application process for this scheme. During this time much of the content of the Transport Assessment (TA) prepared for the site was agreed. Those matters agreed were:

- Trip rates for all land uses
- Trip Distribution
- Trip assignment onto the highway network
- Traffic Growth and Committed Development
- Forecast model methodology (but not design years)

POSITIVE ABOUT DISABLED PEOPLE
INVESTOR IN PEOPLE
Department for Transport

Having reviewed the TA we consider that all the above matters have been applied in line with our agreement.

Matters which do remain outstanding are the use of appropriate assessment years in line with the latest guidance contained in Circular 02/2013 and the interpretation of modelling outputs. Brookbanks have been made aware of these requirements previously. The travel plan also requires strengthening.

Until such time that these matters are agreed we will not be able to provide confirmation that any changes to the A419 are deemed appropriate or that the junction assessments affecting the A419 are accepted. More detail is included in the accompanying technical note.

Given the outstanding information that is required we consider it necessary to implement a Direction of Non-approval for a period of 6 months. Should the applicant address the outstanding matters to our satisfaction, inside the 6 month period, we will lift the Direction of Non-approval. The lifting of the direction will most likely be subject to a request for planning conditions to be implemented as part of any permission granted.

If you wish to discuss any of the issues raised in this letter, please contact me.

Yours sincerely

Ed Halford
Asset Manager
Network Delivery and Development South West
Email: ed.halford@highways.gsi.gov.uk

Cc Chris Sibthorpe - JMP

HIGHWAYS AGENCY

Safe roads, reliable journeys, informed travellers

TR110 (November 2011)

Developments Affecting Trunk Roads and Special Roads
Highways Agency Response to an Application for Planning Permission

From: Divisional Director, Network Delivery and Development, south west, Highways Agency.

To: Swindon Borough Council

Council's Reference: S/OUT/13/1555

Referring to the notification of a planning application dated 14th November 2013, your reference S/OUT/13/1555 , in connection with the A419, Eastern Villages, Swindon, notice is hereby given under the Town and Country Planning (Development Management Procedure) (England) Order 2010 that the Secretary of State for Transport:-

~~a) offers no objection;~~

~~b) advises that planning permission should either be refused, or granted only subject to conditions~~

~~c) directs conditions to be attached to any planning permission which may be granted;~~

~~d) directs that planning permission is not granted for an indefinite period of time;~~

e) directs that planning permission not be granted for a specified period (see Annex A).

(delete as appropriate)

Signed by authority of the Secretary of State for Transport

Date: 10 December 2013	**Signature:**
Name: Ed Halford	**Position:** Asset Manager

The Highways Agency: Level 1
Ash House
Falcon Road
Sowton Industrial Estate
Exeter
EX2 7LB

Annex A

Condition(s) to be attached to any grant of planning permission:

Reason(s) for the direction given at b), c) or d) overleaf and the period of time for a direction at e) when directing that the application is not granted for a specified period:

Swindon Borough Council shall not grant permission for the planning application S/OUT/13/1555 for a period of six months from the date of the Direction for the following reason:-

To allow the applicant sufficient time to submit the further information required to enable the Highways Agency to assess the impact of the proposed development on the Strategic Road Network and that junction assessments affecting the A419 are accepted.